

Handout 3.10: Listening Checklist and I-Message Frame

Name: _____ Date: _____ Partner: _____

Directions: Part 1 is the listening game. Part 2 is the four listening moves. Part 3 is the I-message frame with practice. Part 4 is the partner checklist you fill while your partner listens to you. The exit card is at the bottom.

Part 1: Draw/See/Hear, the listening round

Rules: the describer holds the card so the drawer cannot see it and describes it in words only. The drawer draws on scrap paper. For the first 45 seconds, the drawer may not ask any questions. When the teacher says “questions open,” the drawer may ask. Two minutes total. Then compare.

One thing that got better after questions opened: _____

Picture cards (teacher cuts these apart; one pair of cards per pair of students, face down)

Card A. A house in the middle of the page. The house is a square with a triangle roof. One door in the middle of the front, two square windows, one on each side of the door. A round sun in the top right corner. A tree on the left side of the house, taller than the house, with a round top. Three birds drawn as small “m” shapes in the sky on the left.

Card B. A table in the middle of the page, seen from the side, with four legs. On the table, from left to right: a tall glass, a round plate with a triangle of pizza on it, a small square napkin. Under the table, a cat sitting up, facing right. A window above the table on the right side, with a half moon in it.

Part 2: The four listening moves

Move	What it looks like	Icon
Eyes	Look at the speaker. Phone face down.	an eye
Body	Turn toward them. Nod. Arms open, not folded.	a person turned toward another
Restate	Say it back: “So you are saying ____.”	a speech bubble with an arrow back
Ask	One question: “What happened next?” “What do you need?”	a question mark

Hearing is what your ears do. Listening is what you do.

Part 3: The I-message

A you-statement blames: "You always ____." The other person argues back.

An I-message says what you feel and what you need. Nobody has to argue with a feeling.

I feel [a feeling word] **when** [what happened] **because** [why it matters] **and I need** [one specific thing].

Feeling words: frustrated, left out, worried, embarrassed, hurt, annoyed, confused, nervous, ignored, unheard.

Two traps:

- A fake I-message: "I feel like you are a thief." The word after "I feel" has to be a feeling.
- A vague need: "I need you to be better." A need is something the other person could do tomorrow.

Example 1 (done with the class). You-statement: "You always take my stuff without asking." I-message: I feel frustrated when my charger gets taken without asking because then my phone is dead by lunch, and I need you to ask first.

Example 2 (do it with the class). You-statement: "You never save me a seat." I feel _____ when _____ because _____, and I need _____.

Sentence frame in other languages

English	Turkish	Portuguese	Spanish
I feel ____ when ____ because , and I need .	____ olduğunda ____ hissediyorum çünkü , ve ihtiyacım var.	Eu me sinto ____ quando ____ porque , e eu preciso de .	Me siento ____ cuando ____ porque , y necesito .
So you are saying ____.	Yani ____ diyorsun.	Então você está dizendo que ____.	Entonces lo que dices es ____.

Part 4: Practice pairs

Pick a you-statement from the list. Rewrite it as an I-message below. Say it to your partner. Your partner listens with all four moves and answers with a restate and one question. Check off the moves your partner used. Then switch.

You-statements (1 to 5 for everyone; 6 to 7 next; 8 to 10 are the stretch):

1. "You always cut in front of me in line."
2. "You took the last one and did not even ask."
3. "You never pass the ball."
4. "You keep touching my things."
5. "You are always late and we miss the bus."
6. "You laughed when I messed up."

7. "You told everyone what I said."
8. "You added people to the group chat without asking any of us."
9. "You started a rumor about my friend."
10. "You made the rule that I cannot go out on weekends and never told me why."

My I-message 1 (from you-statement number ____):

I feel _____ when _____ because _____,
and I need _____.

Partner's listening moves (check the ones your partner used): ☐ eyes ☐ body ☐ restate ☐ ask

My I-message 2 (from you-statement number ____):

I feel _____ when _____ because _____,
and I need _____.

Partner's listening moves: ☐ eyes ☐ body ☐ restate ☐ ask

The move my partner said was my weakest as a listener: _____ One fix:

Exit card: 3-2-1

3 listening moves from memory: _____

2 parts of the I-message frame: _____

1 person outside this room (a role, not a name) I could use an I-message with this week:

Teacher key

- Part 1: any sensible answer; the point is that the drawing improved after questions opened (position, size, or count got fixed).
- Part 3, Example 2, a strong answer: “I feel left out when there is no seat saved for me at lunch because it looks like nobody wanted me there, and I need you to save the seat next to you or text me if you cannot.”
- Part 4: an I-message earns “all four parts” when the word after “I feel” is a feeling (not “like you”), the “when” describes what happened without “always” or “never,” the “because” says why it matters, and the need is one thing the other person could do tomorrow.
- Sample strong rewrites: 1. “I feel annoyed when someone steps in front of me in line because I was already waiting, and I need you to go behind me.” 3. “I feel left out when the ball never comes to me because I am open and ready, and I need you to look for me on the next play.” 8. “I feel uncomfortable when people are added to our chat without asking because I do not know who is reading what I write, and I need us to agree before anyone is added.”
- The exit card’s “3” line is checked for three of: eyes, body, restate, ask.